

ver their true understanding faithfully and uprightly ; and the case being between two for private interest, and inheritance earnestly called on for justice and expedition.

“ We hold it, therefore, our duty to inform your Majesty, that our oath is in these express words : that, in case any letter came unto us, contrary to law, that we do nothing by such letters, but certify your Majesty thereof, and go forth to do the law, notwithstanding the same letters.

“ We have advisedly considered of the said letter of Mr. Attorney, and, with one consent, do hold the same to be contrary to law, and such as we could not yield to by our oaths, assuredly persuading ourselves that your Majesty being truly informed that it standeth not with your royal and just pleasure to give way to them.

“ And therefore knowing your Majesty’s zeal to justice to be most renowned, therefore we have, according to our oaths and duties at the very day prefixed, the last Term, proceeded and thereof certified your Majesty, and shall ever pray to the Almighty for your Majesty, in all honour, health, and happiness, long to reign over us.*”

To this firm and temperate address, signed by

* Act of Council, Bacon’s Works, vol. 5, p. 424.